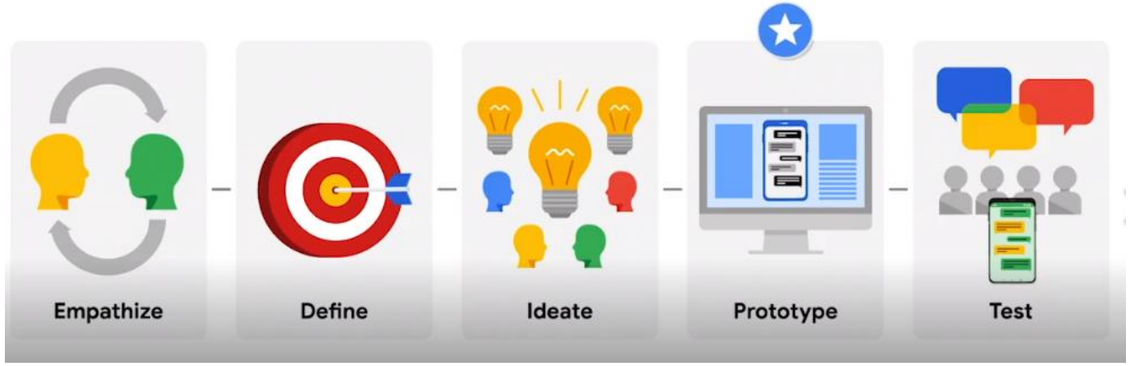
TRƯỜNG ĐẠI HỌC FPT

use research to inform the ideation process

Prototypes

- use research to inform the ideation process, build storyboards and explain how storyboards are used to create wireframes, draw basic elements like shapes and lines, understand information architecture, create paper wireframes, build digital wireframes on a tool called Figma, construct low-fidelity paper prototypes, develop low-fidelity digital prototypes on Figma, and understand how to avoid the effects of deceptive patterns in designs.
- Keep in mind that throughout this course, you'll continue to build on a project for your portfolio.



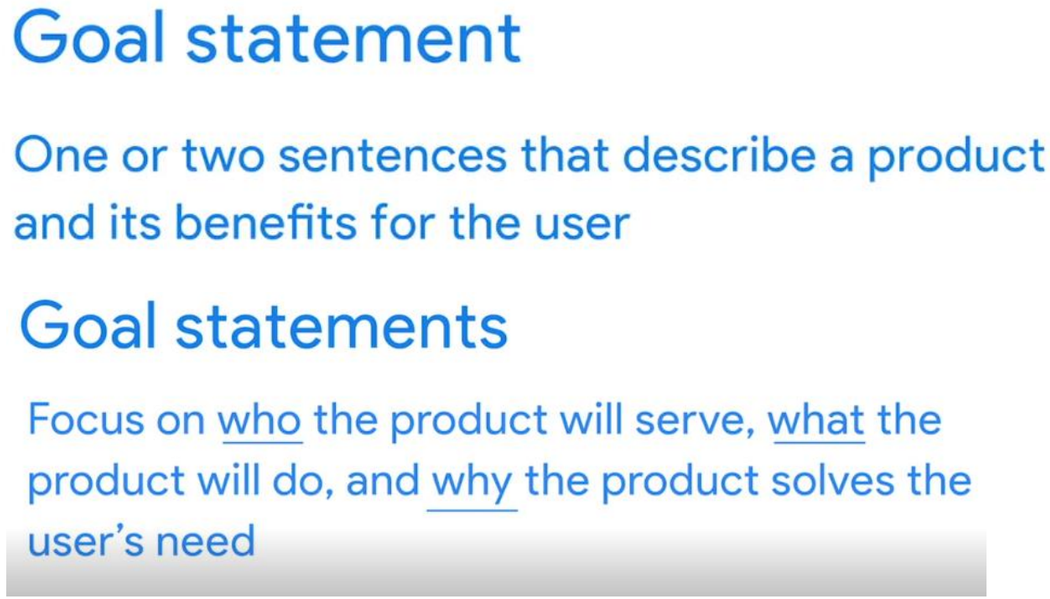
- Use research to inform the ideation process
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- Create paper wireframes
- Build digital wireframes on a tool called Figma
- Construct low-fidelity paper prototypes
- Develop low-fidelity digital prototypes on Figma
- Understand how to avoid the effects of deceptive patterns in design

User Research to inform idea

1. **Empathize with Users:** We began by using empathy maps, personas, user stories, and user journey maps to identify and understand the pain points of users.
2. **Use Tools for Understanding:** We utilized empathy maps to grasp user behaviors and motivations, which include what users say, think, do, and feel, to understand their experiences deeply.
3. **Create Personas:** Personas, fictional characters representing user groups, were developed to focus our design efforts on meeting their specific goals and needs.
4. **Develop User Stories:** User stories, brief narratives from the persona's perspective, were crafted to inspire and guide our design decisions, focusing on essential user needs.
5. **Map User Journeys:** We constructed user journey maps to visualize the sequence of interactions a user has with the product, aiming to address and alleviate pain points effectively.
6. **Synthesize Insights:** All these tools helped us formulate a problem statement that clearly outlines the user needs our design should meet, setting the stage for ideation and solution development.

Create Goal Statement

- **Creation of a Goal Statement:** This section explains the process of formulating a goal statement. This statement is composed of one or two sentences that articulate the product's utility and its advantages for the user, effectively offering an ideal solution for the design challenges addressed.
- **Defining the Goal Statement:** Here, the conversation focuses on using the problem statement to define who the product is for, what it aims to accomplish, and why it is a valuable solution for the user's needs.
- **Practical Application Example:** We apply the goal statement development process to a hypothetical scenario involving the design of an app for finding and scheduling dog walkers.
- **Linking Insights to Goal Statement:** This part elaborates on how to extract relevant details from the problem statement to clearly define who the product serves, what functionalities it offers, and why these are beneficial to the user.



Goal Statement

PROBLEM STATEMENT

_____ is a _____
user name — user characteristics

who needs _____
user need

because _____ .
insight

PROBLEM STATEMENT

Drew is a pet owner in a small town
user name — user characteristics

who needs to find and schedule a dog walker
user need

because they work the night shift .
insight

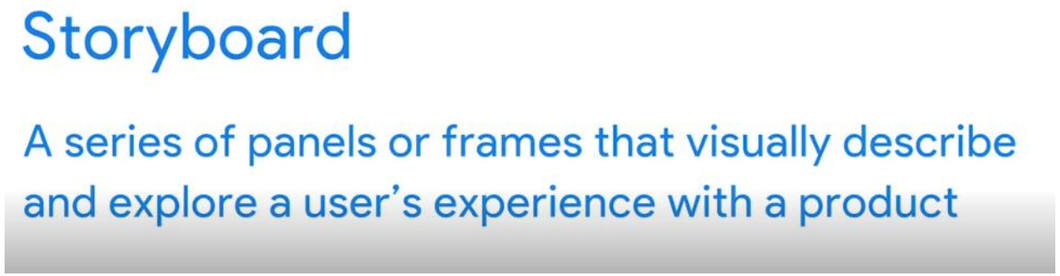
GOAL STATEMENT

Help users with pets find and schedule dog walkers quickly and easily

Storyboard

•A storyboard is a series of panels or frames that visually describe and explore a user's experience with a product. Keep in mind, we've made the transition from the problem the user is facing to coming up with ideas for solutions we can provide as UX designers.

•The four key elements of a storyboard are the character, the scene, the plot, and the narrative. The first element, character, is the user in your story. The next element, the scene, helps us imagine the user's environment. The plot describes the benefit or solution of the design. Finally, the narrative describes the user's need or problem and how the design will solve the problem.

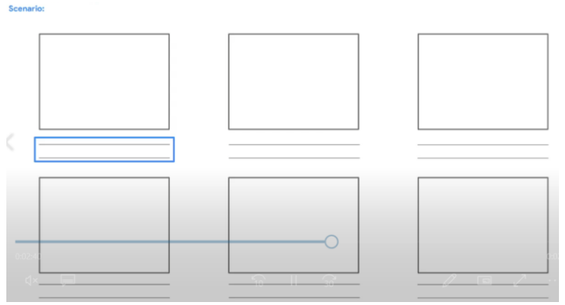


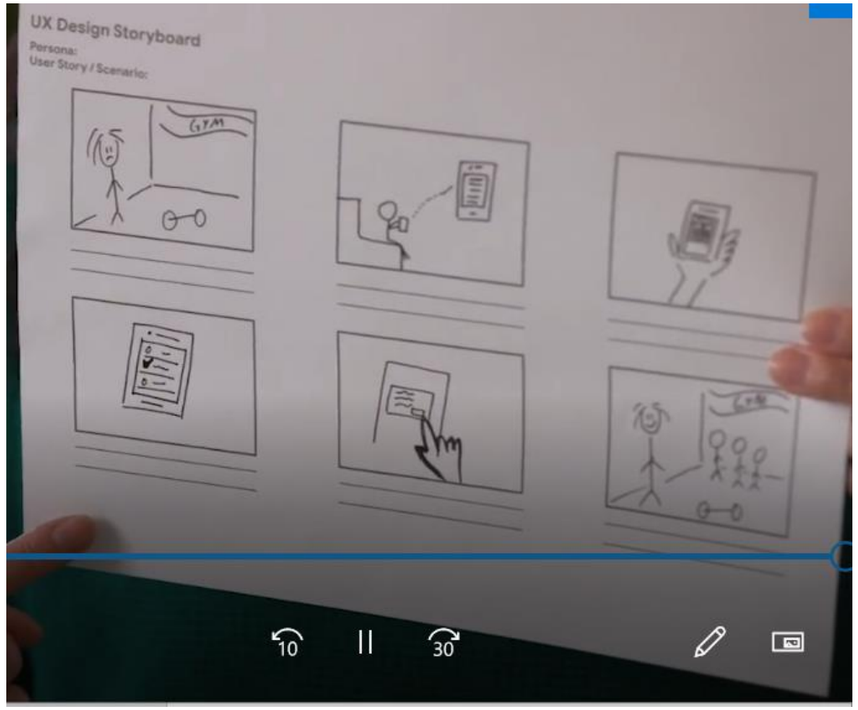


Storyboard

•Let's revisit a problem statement from course 2. Amal is an athlete who needs a way to sign up for workout classes because the class he wants to participate in fills up fast.

• Our first step is to turn this problem statement into a goal statement. Our goal statement could be: Help users who are athletes sign up for workout classes early and quickly. Now it's time to storyboard.





Storyboard

- storyboards are often used to outline movies. In the film world, storyboards are used before a movie is created to show how each scene of the movie will play out for a character.
- There are actually two types of storyboards. Keeping movies in mind, these two types of storyboards are called big picture and close-up.

Big picture storyboard

Focuses on the user experience

Close-up storyboard

Focuses on the product

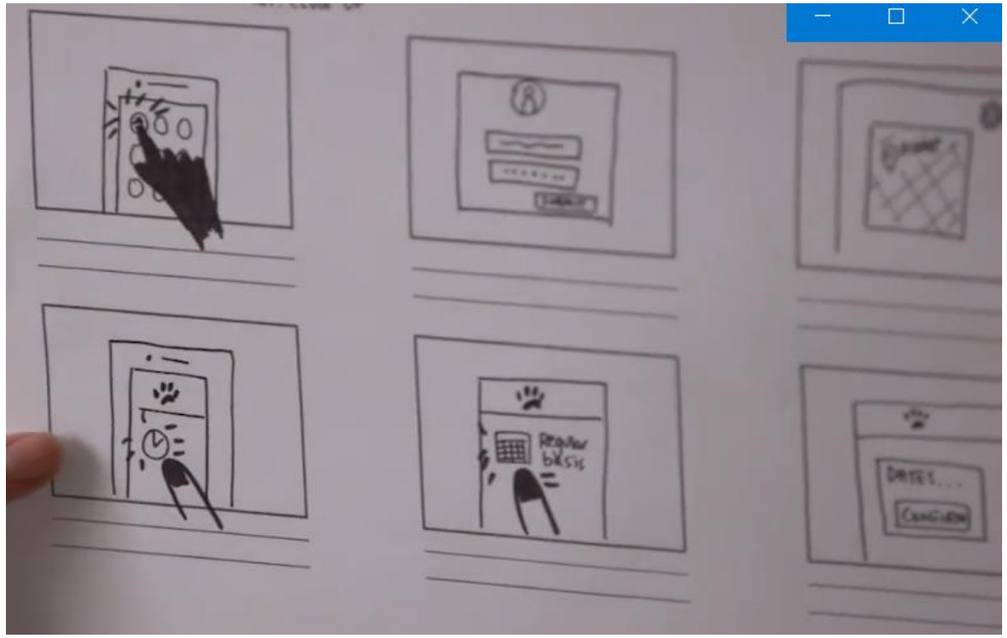
big-picture storyboard

- First, let's discuss a big-picture storyboard, which focuses on the user experience. Big picture storyboards think about how people will use the product throughout their day and why that product will be useful.
- This helps you understand the entire user experience, including the different challenges, potential pain points, and types of interactions the user will encounter.
- Like a good movie, a big picture storyboard can show the emotional engagement that a user will have with our app or with any product. Understanding how a user feels while experiencing your product is an essential part of the design process.



close-up storyboard

- The close-up storyboard is less about emotion, since we're not focused on the user. Instead, the close-up storyboard is focused on the practicalities of the design itself. So how do you decide which type of storyboard to use?
- To decide, it's helpful to think about this stage of the design process you're in. If you're early in the design process, you might want to present your high-level ideas to stakeholders to get them excited and bought in.



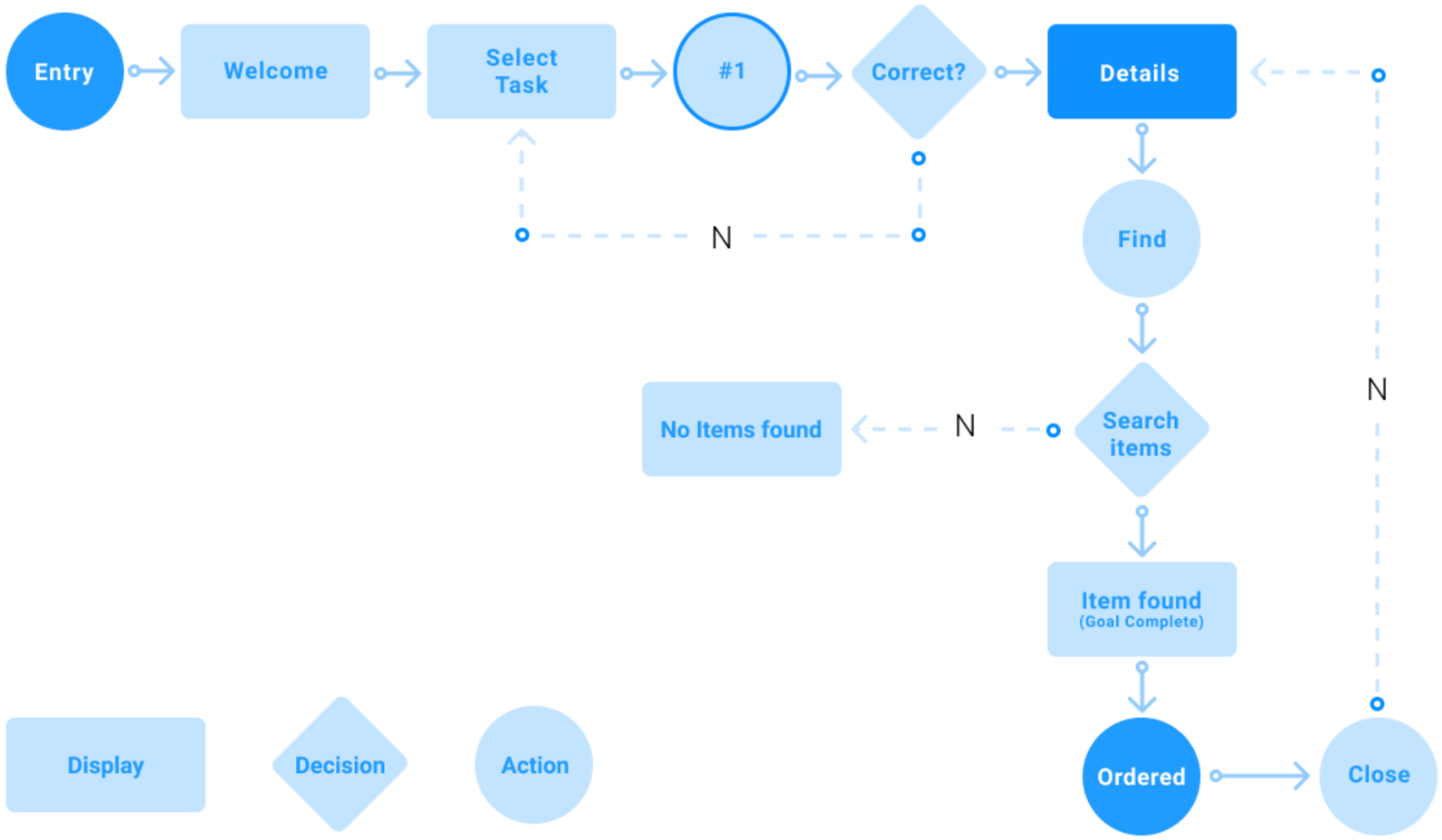
User Flows

- What are user flows?
- Why do we use user flows?

- What are user flows?

There are many different pathways a user can take when interacting with a product. A user flow is a visual representation, either written out or made digitally, of the many avenues that can be taken when using an app or website.

The flowchart begins with the consumer's entry point on the product, like an onboarding screen or homepage, and ends with the final action or outcome, like purchasing a product or signing up for an account. Depicting this process allows designers to evaluate and optimize the user experience and therefore increase client conversion rates.


Entry
Welcome
Select Task
#1
Correct?
Details
N
Find
No Items found
N
Search items
N
Item found
(Goal Complete)
Ordered
Close
Display
Decision
Action

Each touchpoint on the **user's journey** is represented by a node in the flow chart. These nodes are characterized by shape, and each shape indicates a particular process. For instance, a diamond means a decision is being made and is therefore followed by "Yes" and "No" arrows. A rectangle indicates a task or action that needs to be taken, like "Log in" or "Purchase".

Why do we use user flows in UX design?

- Now that we've established what UX flows are, we can look into why they are so beneficial to the design process. Studying the user flow of a website or app can prove useful whether you are designing a brand new product or revamping an old one.
- User flows are extremely useful if you need to:

Create an intuitive interface

- The main benefit of designing a product where users can get “in the zone” quickly is the ability to increase the probability of a user purchasing or signing up for the client’s product. Another benefit is enhancing the ease of movement through your platform, making sure the user’s time isn’t being wasted looking for what to do next. Of course, there is often more than one route a user could follow to complete the task. User flows portray these possible patterns in a way that makes it easy for designers to assess the efficiency of the interface they are creating.

Evaluate existing interfaces

- For products that are already in use, user flow charts help determine what's working, what's not, and what areas need improvement. It helps to identify why users might be stalling at a certain point and what you can do to fix it. Does one screen flow into the next? Does the pattern of the screens make sense? Mapping out the movement within an interface in a blueprint type fashion helps you see what options the user has on each page and if the routes available help the user accomplish a task innately and without wasting time.

Present your product to clients or colleagues

- User flows also easily communicate the flow of the product to your stakeholders and provide a general view of how the interface you've created is intended to work in its most efficient form. They provide a step-by-step breakdown of what the customer will see and do in order to purchase, log in, sign up, etc. Helping your design team visualize how users will move through the product ensures everyone is on the same page—which allows for a more productive and rewarding work environment.

Types of user flow charts (with examples)

Where do user flows fit into the UX design process?

1. Types of user flow charts

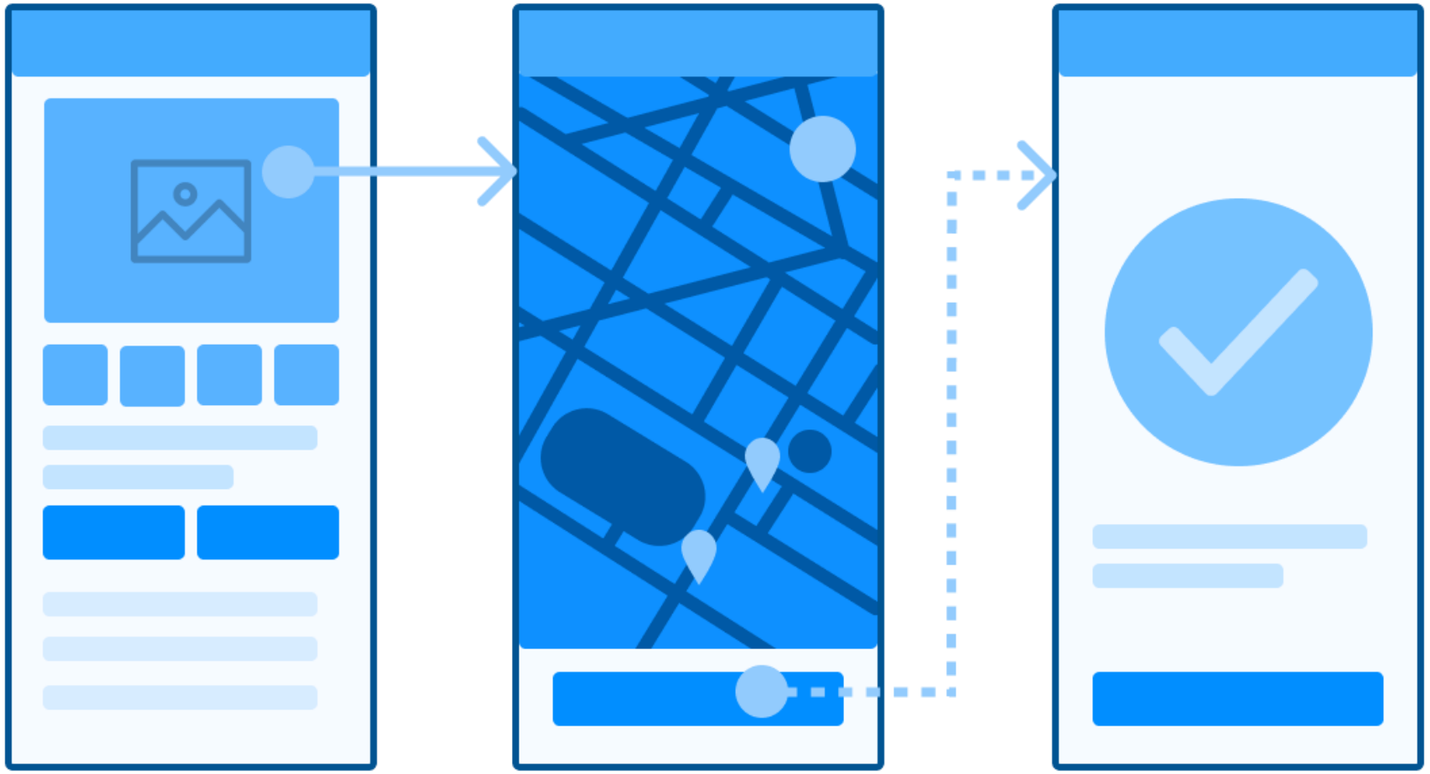
UX flows can be used for all kinds of interface and web design, but certain types of flowcharts are more valuable than others depending on what you are creating. Here we describe a few of the user flow variations and when to use them.

- **Task flows**



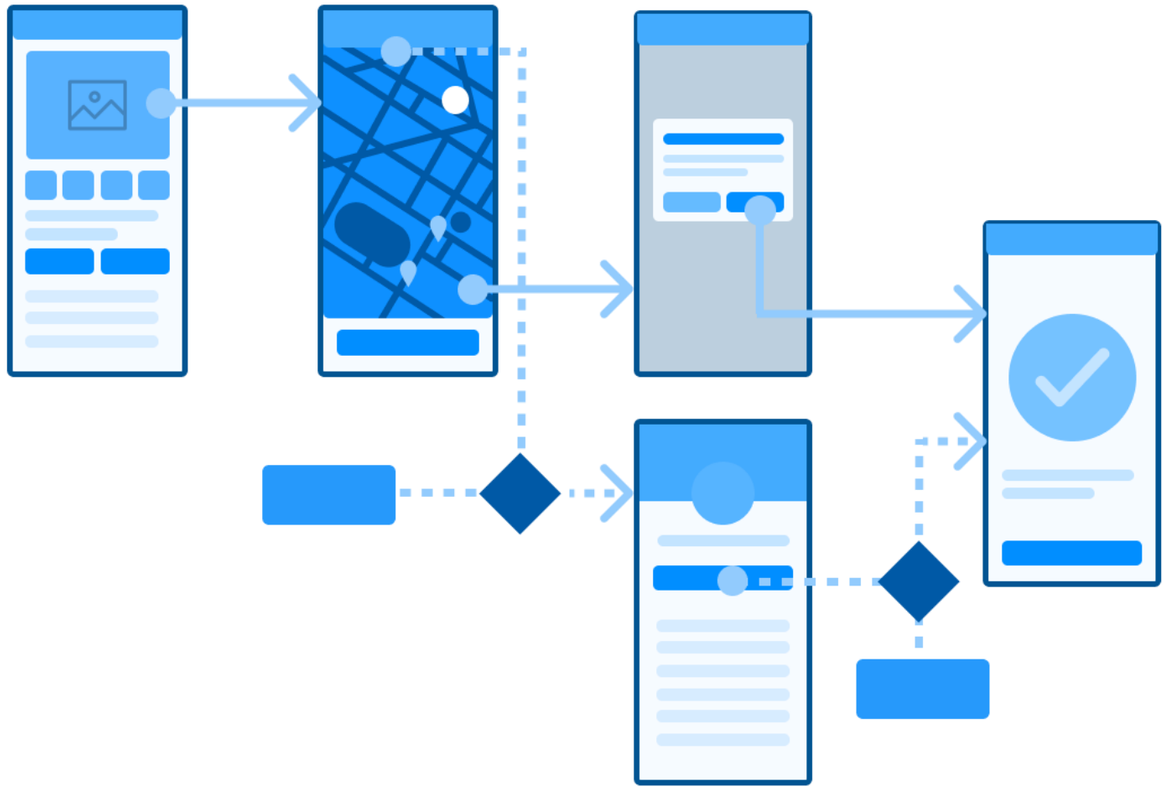
Task flows focus on how users travel through the platform while performing a specific task. They generally show only one path and don’t include multiple branches or pathways like a traditional user flow might. These are best used when the task being analyzed is accomplished similarly by all users. When using task flows, it is assumed that all users will share a common starting point and have no variability in the way the task is carried out.

- **Wire flows**



- Wireflows are **a combination of wireframes and flowcharts**. They utilize the layout of individual screens as elements within the diagram. Wireframes on their own help convey the layout and design on each individual page, but lack the ability to communicate the page-to-page flow of heavily dynamic interfaces. Wireflows add page context to UX flows, since what users see on each screen greatly impacts their experience through the app or website. Wireflows are especially great when creating mobile screens. The relatively small size of the mobile screens are easily used to replace the more abstract shapes of flow charts.

- **User flows**



- User flows focus on the way your target audience will interact with the product. They emphasize that all users might not perform tasks the same and may travel in different paths. They are typically attached to a specific persona and entry point. Therefore, when using this type of flowchart, you may have many different scenarios that start at different places. However, the main task or accomplishment is usually always the same.

- **Where do user flows fit into the UX design process?**

UX flows are synthesized early, during the planning stages of your design—after user research has been conducted. They form an important part of the foundation on which your product is built, and can serve as a reference for other designers. Once you have gathered your data from user testing, user flows help determine how many screens are needed, what order they should appear in, and what components need to be present. By the time you get to creating a user flow, your **affinity diagrams** and **empathy mapping** as well as persona development have all been completed. Flowcharts can also be made for existing interfaces to enhance the user's experience or clear up any trouble users are having with the interface.

- User flows are considered part of your deliverables, the elements you provide to the client and design team when your product is finished. Presenting a detailed flowchart can help validate your design decisions to your colleagues. However, designs are constantly being revised and user flows may be revisited and edited if further research deems it necessary.

Key takeaways

- The mark of a successful app or website is in the intuitiveness of its design. When users can easily flow through an interface without hesitation or confusion, there is a greater likelihood that they will purchase the client's product or visit the site again. User flows are a great tool for any designer's toolbox as they can assist in evaluating the efficiency and simplicity of your creative design. At the same time, flowcharts and UX flows assist other members of the design team and easily communicate the layout of an interface to partners and investors. By providing a visual representation of what consumers will encounter, you can ensure your users' experience will be gratifying and free from frustration.

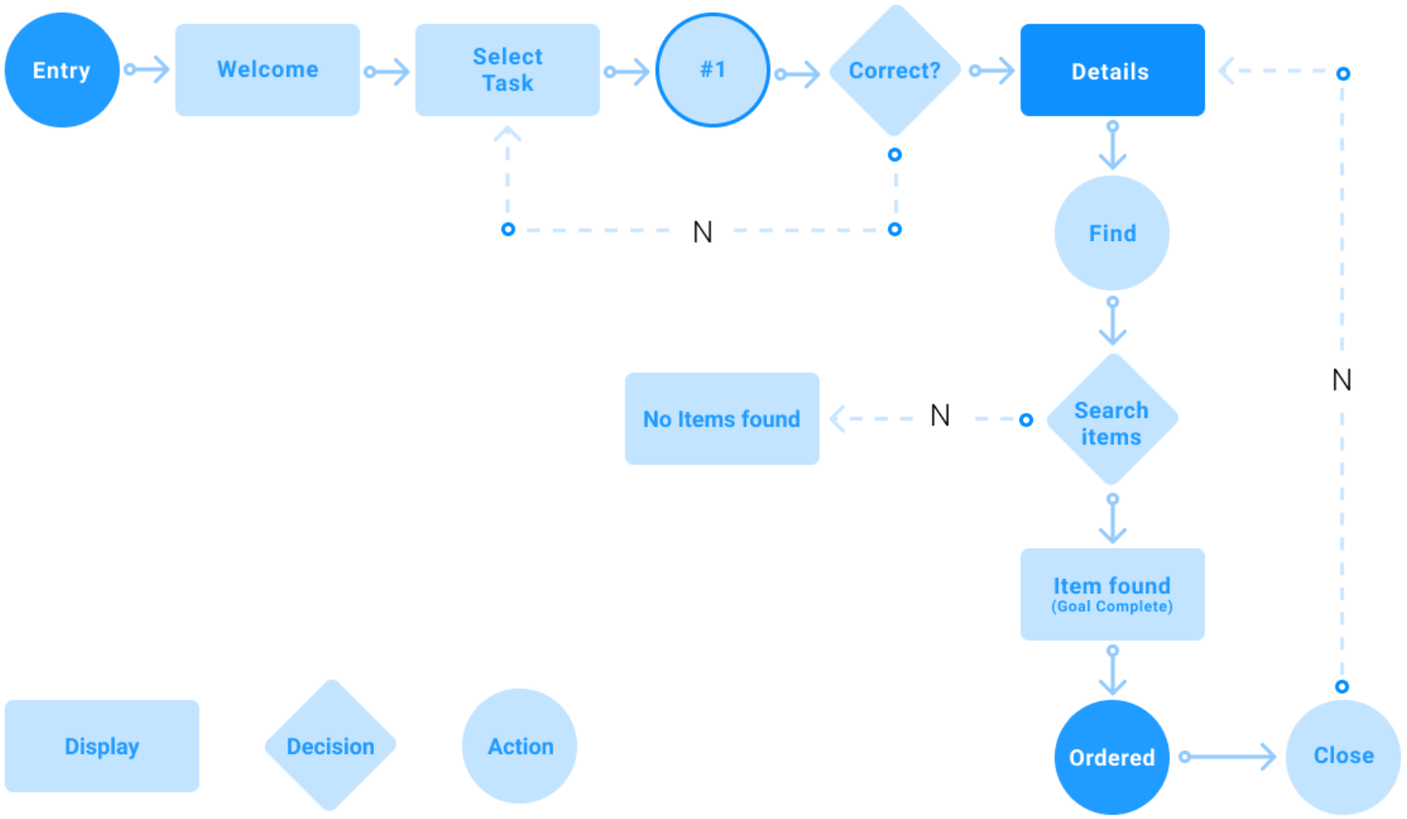
How To Create A User Flow

- User flows are one of the most useful yet misunderstood tools in the UX industry today. Senior designers often avoid them, while junior designers can struggle to get a grip on them.
- In reality, user flows don’t have to be so painstakingly challenging. In this article, we’ll bring some clarity to the complex world of user flows and share a clear step-by-step guide on how to create a user flow.

We’ve broken our guide down into the following steps and sections:

- Understand your user
- How to create a user flow outline
- Define the elements of your user flow
- Refine your outline
- What happens next?

Ready to learn how to create your own user flows?



Understand your user

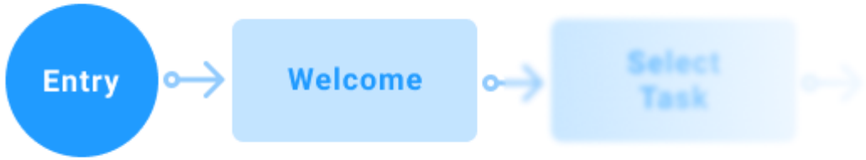
- To design the best possible user flow, you have to have the best possible understanding of **your user**. Understanding the user's needs and motivations allows you to make informed choices when determining how to get users into that flow-like state when interacting with your product. Here are some questions to ask yourself when getting to know your user:
- What are the needs of your users?
- What problems would they like solved?
- What features are most important to them and why?
- What initial questions do they have about your product?
- What information needs to be provided in order for them to effortlessly interact with your product?

How to create a user flow outline

- To understand how to create a user flow, like most things in design, it’s best to start off with a first draft or outline. Start by writing down a basic flow like a mind map. Each box you draw should represent a step in a user action. It can be helpful to outline and breakdown your flow chart into three main stages: an entry point, steps to completion, and the final step in completing a task or the final interaction.

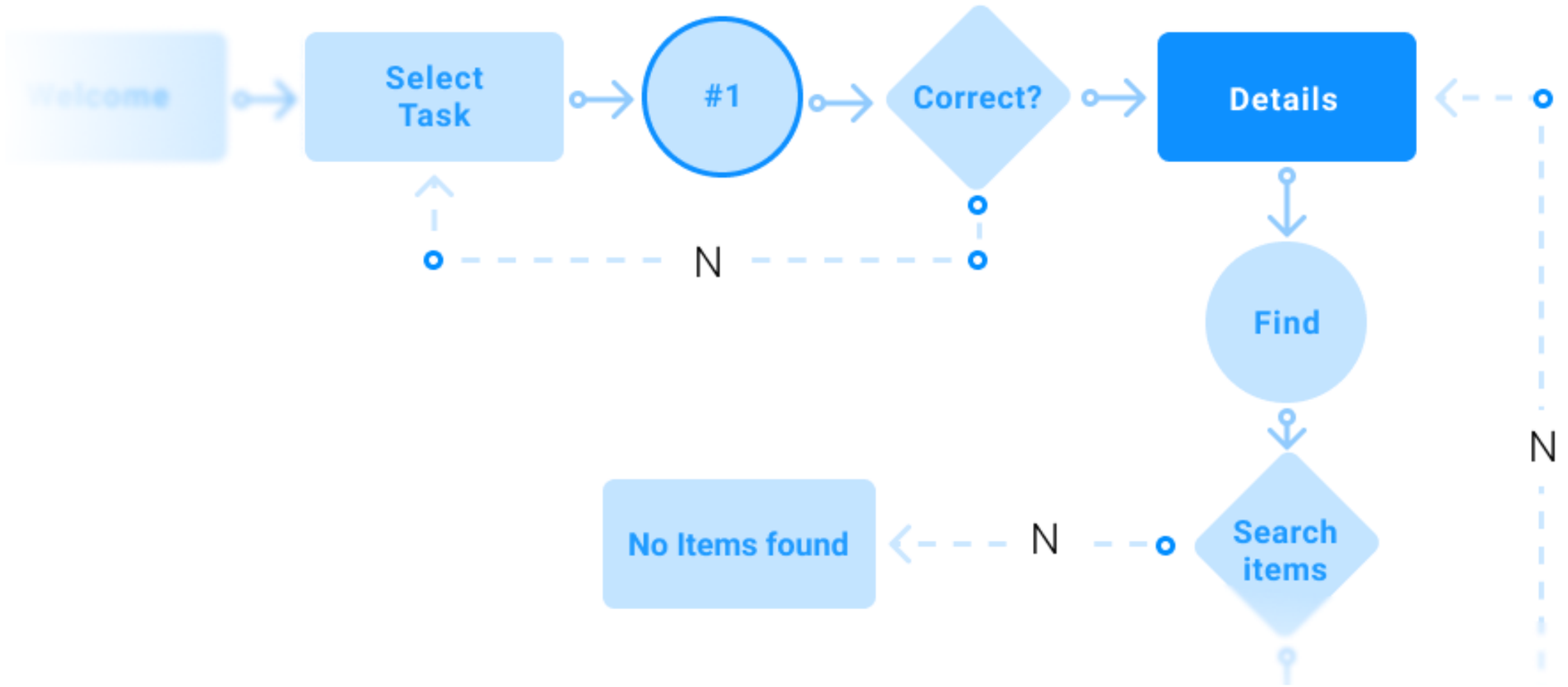
Entry point

- Entry points are the means by which a user accesses the product initially. Websites can have many points of entry, while apps often have limited and distinct entry points. Websites are usually visited by a google search or clicking on product ads and shared hyperlinks. Applications, on the other hand, are most commonly entered from the app store or the downloaded version on a user's phone. However, points of entry for an application can also be an article, links, or advertisements.



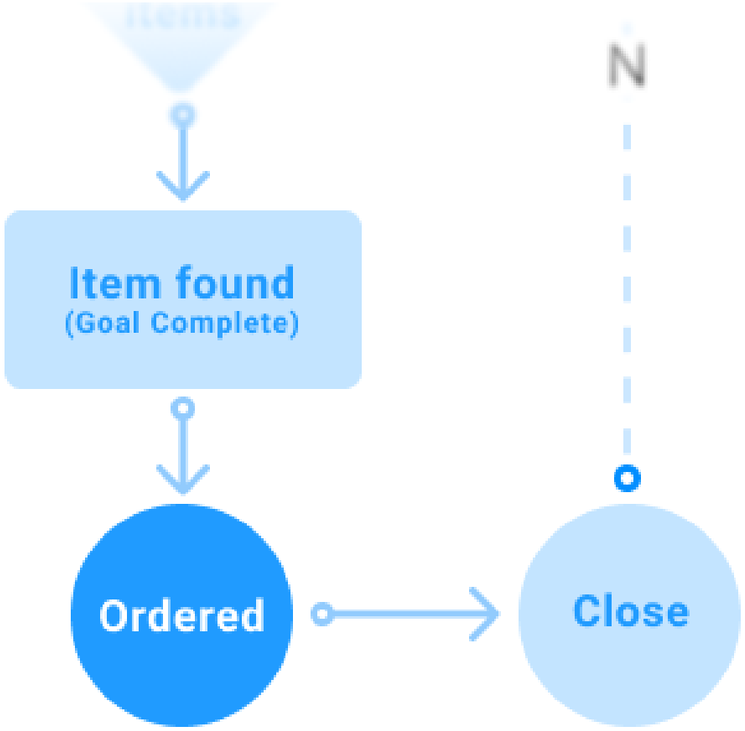
- **Steps to completion**

This is the meat of the flow chart. This stage usually consists of a login or signup screens, onboarding, a home screen, and any screens needed to navigate a task to completion. Remember to keep it simple, making sure each step is vital to the task. Your first draft doesn’t have to explore every facet of your platform. For instance, an entire step-by-step outline of password recovery isn’t crucial at this time. Stick to the steps needed for your user to achieve their ultimate goal.


Welcome
Select Task
#1
Correct?
Details
N
Find
N
No Items found
N
Search items

The final interaction

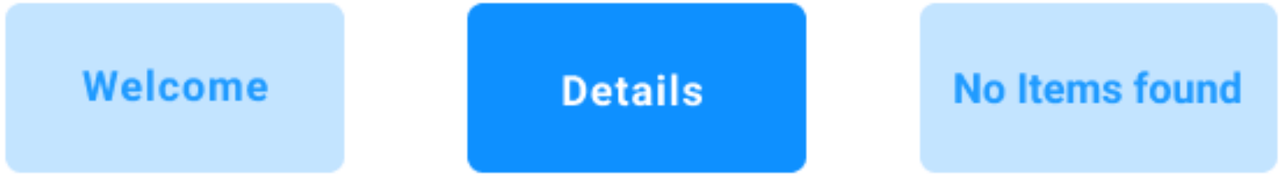
The final interaction is the final screen the user will see when they accomplish the desired task. What screen pops up last to inform them that the task is complete? An example of a final interaction for purchasing an item could be a confirmation screen to inform you that your order has been received. Another example of a final interaction is when completing signing up for an account. Is it best for your product to end with immediate access to the homepage, or would the login page be a better last step?


N
Item found
(Goal Complete)
Ordered
Close

Define the elements of your user flow

- Designers use various shapes and colors to represent a unique set of elements within the interface. Each shape is an interaction or possible interaction and gives the reader more information about what is happening in a particular step. Some shapes are flexible and can be used for multiple actions, like using circles to represent entry/exit points or a connection to a different webpage or screen. Adding a key or legend to your user flow can help your colleagues and clients to better interpret and grasp your diagram. Below, we break down some of the most common shapes used within the industry and when to use them.

Rectangle



The rectangle is arguably the most common shape used in user flows. They usually represent a page or display screen. Unlike circles, there is no action to be taken. Rectangles are best used when depicting things like a homepage, onboarding screen, confirmation page, etc.

- **Lines with arrows**

This is probably the most important part of the user flow as the lines with arrows tie everything together and determine the flow through the chart. Lines with arrows take the reader through the chart from shape to shape, top to bottom, or left to right.

Circle



The circle is used mostly for displaying an action. They show a task that must be completed or steps that must be taken. Use a circle when you want to represent a process, task, or operation. To help determine if you are using a circle properly, check how it is being labeled. Circles are almost always labeled with a verb like “Select Item” or “Send Order”

Diamonds

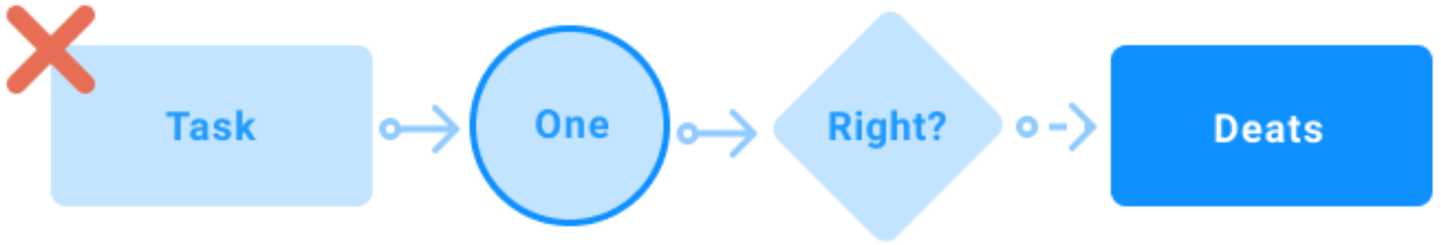


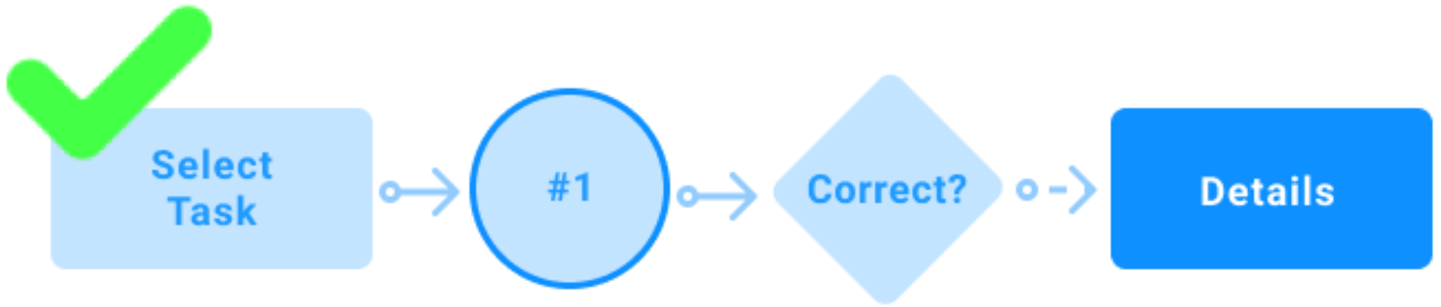
- Commonly termed a “decision diamond”, this shape always asks a question. While other shapes may be interchanged for different purposes, the diamond is consistently used to show when a decision needs to be made. The possible answers to the question being asked are represented by the lines extending out of the diamond and determine which path to follow. For instance, you might ask questions like “Do you have an account?” or “Is this correct?” with yes and no arrows extending from each.
- It’s important to remember that there is no set rule or guideline for how to create a user flow, and one person’s flow chart may look different from the next. As long as you are consistent with your shapes and the reader can follow and understand the flow, you should have a successful user flow.

Refine your outline

- The same principles you follow when designing an interface can and should be applied when designing a UX flowchart. Here are our top three must-apply **UI design principles**
- **Make labels meaningful**

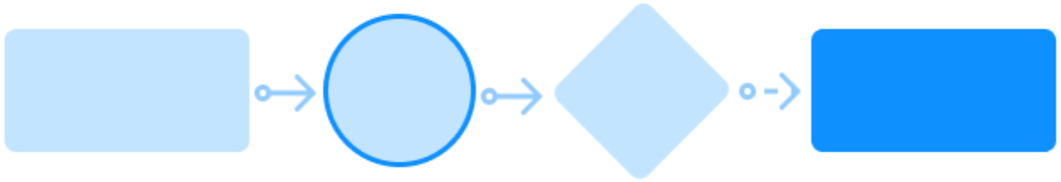
Labels are the reader's lifeline when going through the user flow. The most important label is the flowchart's title. Try to use a title that describes exactly what the user flow represents. If you're not sure if your title is clear, get a colleague to read it over. If they can't tell you what the flowchart is for, you may want to redo it. Additionally, avoid using all capital letters within labels as this has been shown to decrease readability.


Task
One
Right?
Deats


Select Task
#1
Correct?
Details

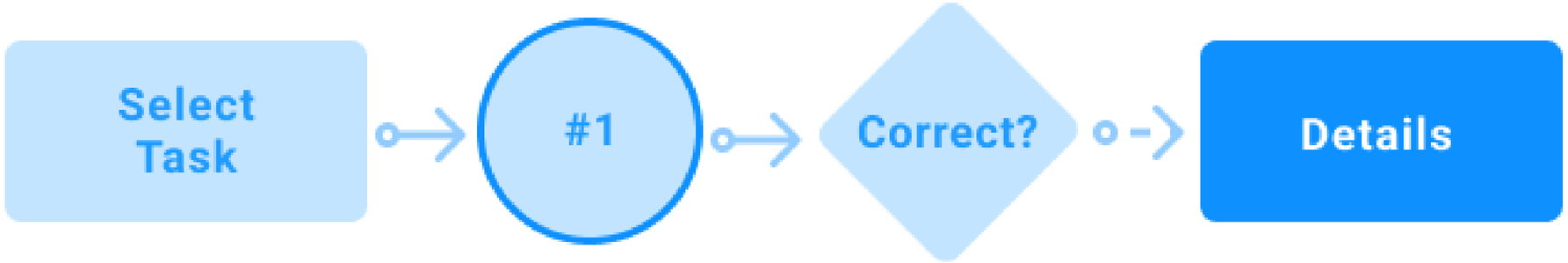
Choose colors wisely

- The main purpose of color in a UX flowchart should be to help the reader identify and group resources as well as highlight important user actions. Colors are best used as a coding system rather than for styling.



Be consistent with the visual structure

- Keeping your visual structure consistent can help ensure that your user flow is easy to follow and isn’t misleading. For instance, shapes and line elements should always be used for the same purpose and accompanied by a key or legend.
- Additionally, consider how you use the real estate of your design. Position elements on the screen logically and consistently for an uncluttered design. Most design tools (including **Justinmind**) have rulers and grids to help you align the elements on the screen.


Select Task
#1
Correct?
Details